# Answers and talk notes

Explore Relationships Between Two Variables

### What your student is learning

Tonight we look at two quantities that change together and decide which one is the independent variable and which is the dependent variable.

## Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** hours worked. hours worked is the independent variable, because you choose how many hours to work.
2. **A.** height of the plant. height of the plant is the dependent variable, because it changes in response to the water.
3. **C.** The first column (input). The first column (input) holds the independent variable.
4. **D.** total cost. total cost depends on the number of pounds, so it is the dependent variable.
5. **B.** It changes because of the other variable. It changes because of the other variable, so it depends on it.

### Talk about it

Which one did you pick first, and which one followed from your pick?

### Home mission

Use coins. Lay out $4 for 1 hour and $8 for 2 hours of stand work. Ask, "Which number do we choose? Which one depends on it?" Can your student say, "The pay depends on the hours"?

### When they are stuck, ask

- Which one did someone get to decide?
- Which one changed because of the other?
- Can you say it with the words "depends on"?

### Try not to say

- The first one mentioned is always independent.
- It does not matter which is which.
- The bigger number is the dependent variable.